The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which products and services are growing?

Period: May 2026. Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

May 2026 Locked May 2026 is locked (closed 2 Jun 2026). These numbers won't change.

Services

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Gross margin = revenue less contractors and consultant time charged to the work at $60 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: consultant time not charged to clients, and overheads (management and admin wages, marketing, rent, IT, insurance, travel, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

May's client work made $57,240 gross margin (67.4%). Consultant time not charged to client work took $28,140 and overheads $51,750, leaving ($22,650) profit before tax ((26.7%) of revenue). To cover overheads, client work needs a 94.1% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on client work	$57,240
Consultant wages and on-costs	$54,720
Consultant time charged to client work (at cost)	$26,580
Consultant time not charged to client work	$28,140
Gross profit (the P&L)	$29,100
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$51,750
Profit before tax (the P&L)	($22,650)
Revenue	$84,920
Gross margin on client work, %	67.4%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	(26.7%)
Gross margin client work need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**94.1%**

Type of work: All

May against May last year
(19.1%)
$84,920 against $104,970

Year to date (Jul to May 2026)
$983,910
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
67.4%
$662,890 before overheads

What it shows

Revenue is $983,910 this financial year to date (Jul to May 2026). Training makes the highest gross margin (77.3%); Projects the lowest (65.4%). The business needs 94.1% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Projects: 65.4% gross margin, 25.4 points over the 40.0% target ($155,026 ahead on $611,410 this financial year to date). Training: 77.3% gross margin, 37.3 points over the 40.0% target ($31,020 ahead on $83,200 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Projects

May against May last year
(26.6%)
$48,120 against $65,570

Year to date (Jul to May 2026)
$611,410
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
65.4%
$399,590 before overheads

What it shows
Projects brought in $611,410 this financial year to date, at a 65.4% gross margin (below the 67.4% overall).

What you'd do about it
Projects: 65.4% gross margin, 25.4 points over the 40.0% target ($155,026 ahead on $611,410 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Retainers

May against May last year
29.6%
$31,100 against $24,000

Year to date (Jul to May 2026)
$289,300
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
68.8%
$199,000 before overheads

What it shows
Retainers brought in $289,300 this financial year to date, at a 68.8% gross margin (above the 67.4% overall).

What you'd do about it
Retainers: 68.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 40.0% target ($83,280 ahead on $289,300 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Training

May against May last year
(63.0%)
$5,700 against $15,400

Year to date (Jul to May 2026)
$83,200
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
77.3%
$64,300 before overheads

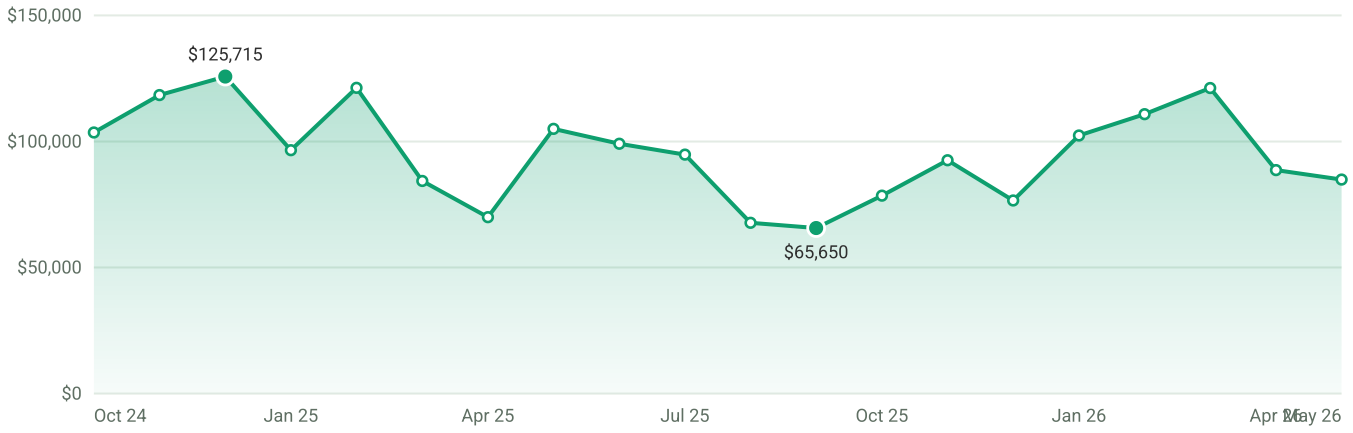
What it shows
Training brought in $83,200 this financial year to date, at a 77.3% gross margin (above the 67.4% overall).

What you'd do about it
Training: 77.3% gross margin, 37.3 points over the 40.0% target ($31,020 ahead on $83,200 this financial year to date).

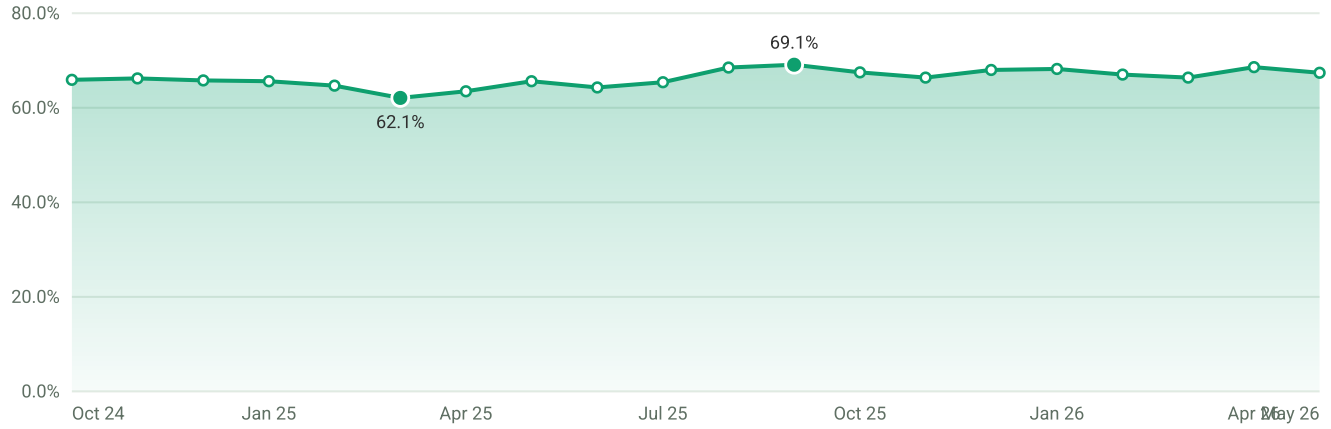
Every type of work at once

Revenue, gross margin and growth by type of work, by month

All · Revenue $



All · Gross margin %



Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

By type of work: financial year to date (Jul to May 2026) against the same period last year

	Year to date	Same period last year	Growth	Gross margin $	Gross margin %
Projects	$611,410	–	–	$399,590	65.4%
Retainers	$289,300	–	–	$199,000	68.8%
Training	$83,200	–	–	$64,300	77.3%
Total	$983,910	–	–	$662,890	67.4%

Same period last year: Not available: the data starts October 2024.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.